

Met Gala AI Stylist

Concept Document

Draft — May 2026

The Problem

Every year, Met Gala has a defined theme — in 2025 it was "Superfine: Tailoring Black Style," and in 2026 it was "Fashion as Art." Yet year after year, a majority of celebrities show up in big-name designer pieces that completely miss the brief. The brands are impressive. The dresses are beautiful. But they aren't on theme.

The stylists and houses dressing these celebrities have access to decades of runway catalogs, and often the perfect on-theme look already exists — they just aren't connecting the dots.

The Idea

An AI-powered tool for Met Gala styling: a platform that analyzes the year's theme, evaluates real celebrity looks against that theme, and surfaces better alternatives from designer archives, emerging brands, and global runway data.

Think of it as a research assistant meets creative brief generator meets stylist's mood board — all powered by AI and grounded in real fashion data.

Core Features

1. Theme Analysis & Look Scoring

Input: the year's Met Gala theme. Output: a breakdown of what the theme means aesthetically, historically, and conceptually — so there's a clear rubric for what "on theme" actually looks like.

- AI interprets the theme across dimensions: silhouette, material, era, cultural reference, artistic movement
- Each celebrity look is scored against the theme rubric
- Short explanation of why a look works or misses (e.g. 'Lisa's 3D-printed headgear references wearable sculpture — this is fashion AS art. Kendall's Gap look is fashion ADJACENT to art at best.')

2. Designer Archive Pull

For each celebrity or brand pairing, the tool pulls from the designer's actual runway archives to find past looks that would have nailed the theme.

- Example: Chanel has shown avant-garde, art-forward looks at Paris Fashion Week that Jenny could have worn instead of her standard campaign look
- YSL has archive pieces referencing fine art movements — far more on-theme than what Kendall wore
- This makes the tool actually useful to real stylists — it's not abstract advice, it's 'here is the dress, here is the season it was shown'

3. Emerging Brand Catalog

A curated, rolling database of emerging fashion brands from New York Fashion Week, Paris, Milan, and London — brands that are doing boundary-pushing work aligned with different aesthetic categories.

- Organized by theme tags: futurism, surrealism, cultural heritage, sustainability, wearable tech, etc.
- Each brand entry includes standout looks with images and theme relevance scores
- Updated each fashion week season

4. Thematic Archive (10+ Years of Met Gala)

A browseable archive of every Met Gala theme going back at least 10 years, with:

- The official theme and its interpretation
- Top-rated on-theme looks from that year
- Fashion brands (big and emerging) whose existing catalog best fit that theme
- A mood board of looks that would have worked — surfaced retroactively

Stylists can use this to understand how themes repeat, how fashion houses evolve their aesthetic, and which brands consistently show up for the brief.

Data Sources

- Vogue and WWD for Met Gala look coverage and theme coverage
- Vogue Runway API or scrape for designer runway archives

- Pinterest API (or similar) for mood board and style reference surfacing
 - CFDA, NYFW databases for emerging brand tracking
 - Potentially: Getty Images for look photos, Wikipedia for theme history
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Rough Tech Stack

- Frontend: React + TypeScript, clean editorial UI (think Vogue meets data dashboard)
 - Backend: FastAPI or Node.js
 - AI: Claude API for theme interpretation, look scoring, and suggestion generation
 - Data: PostgreSQL for archive storage, vector DB (ChromaDB or similar) for semantic search across looks
 - Image handling: Cloudinary or similar for fashion look images
 - Integrations: Pinterest API, Vogue Runway data, NYFW brand database
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Who This Is For

- Celebrity stylists building Met Gala looks — this is their research tool
 - Fashion editors and journalists covering the Gala — instant analysis
 - Fashion students and enthusiasts who want to understand theme alignment
 - Brands and PRs pitching looks for celebrity placements
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Looks That Got It Right (2026 — Fashion as Art)

These are the reference points for what the tool should recognize as on-theme:

- Lisa (BLACKPINK): 3D-printed headgear and bodypiece, hands as structural elements. Technology as art. Sculpture as fashion. Perfect.
- Bi (mirror dress with film roll): The film roll is art — cinema is art. The mirror material reflects the idea of fashion reflecting culture. Strong conceptual read.
- Kim Kardashian: Not the most innovative, but committed to the aesthetic. Better than most.

Misses that the tool would flag and restyle:

- Jenny (Chanel): Generic campaign look. Chanel has art-forward archive pieces that would have worked.

- Kendall Jenner (Gap): Gap is not a Met Gala brand. The look read as commercial, not artistic.
 - Rosé (YSL): YSL has a rich art history — Mondrian dress, Andy Warhol era. None of that showed up here.
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Next Steps

- Sketch out the UI — start with the theme analysis + look scoring view
 - Research Pinterest API access and Vogue Runway data availability
 - Define the scoring rubric (what dimensions make a look 'on theme')
 - Build a small prototype with 2026 Met Gala looks as the test dataset
 - Figure out image rights / fair use for runway and red carpet photos
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